Exercise 2

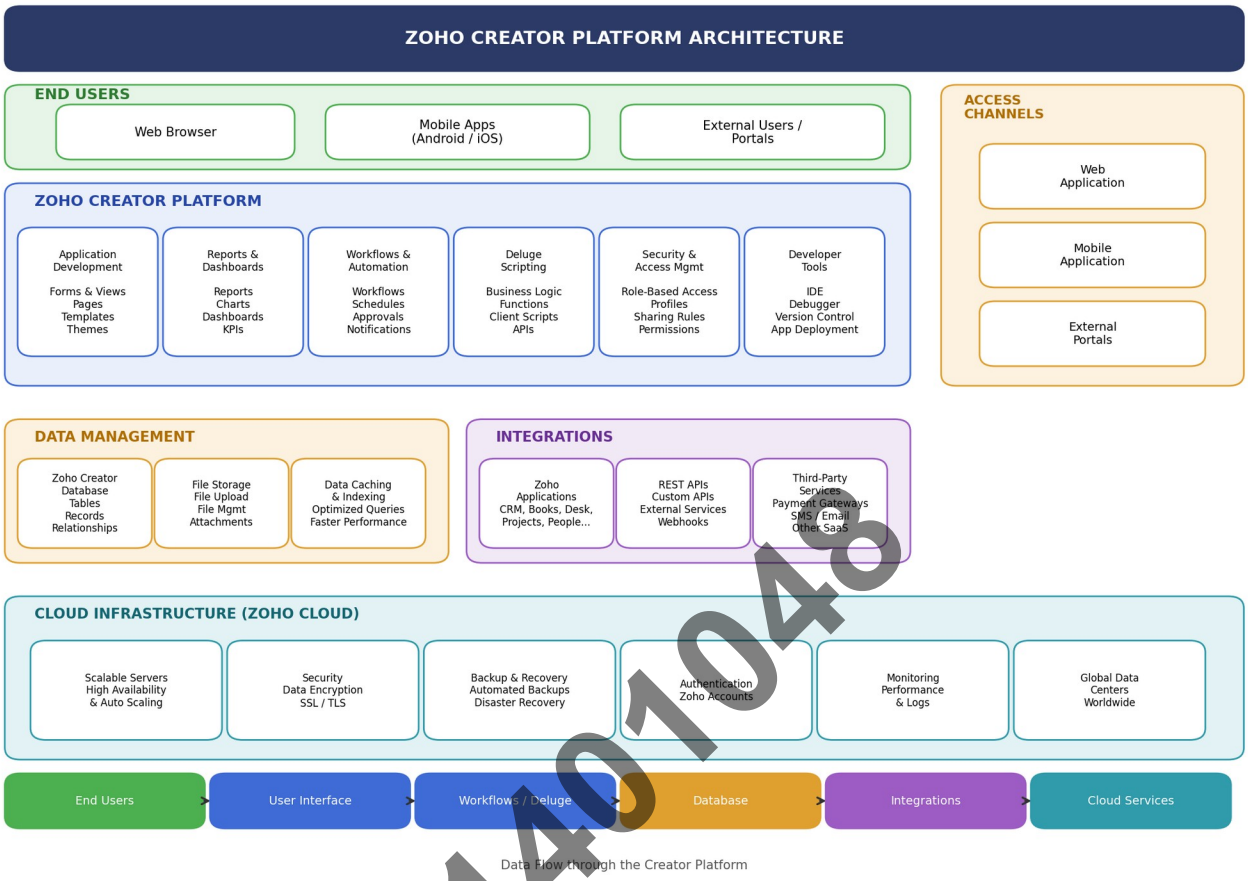
Setting up a Zoho Creator Account and Exploring the Platform Architecture and Interface

Submitted by

LOKRANJAN M

Roll No: 241401048

Architecture Diagram



24140104

Figure 1: Zoho Creator platform architecture

- End Users: users reach the application through a web browser, a mobile app, or an external portal to carry out tasks and manage data.
- Zoho Creator Platform: the core of the system, where applications are built using forms, pages, reports, dashboards, workflows, and Deluge scripting, with role-based security controlling who can access what.
- Data Management: all application data, records, and uploaded files live in the Zoho Creator database, keeping data organized and secure.
- Integrations: the platform connects to other Zoho applications (CRM, Books, Desk, and more), REST APIs, and third-party services such as payment gateways, email, and SMS.
- Cloud Infrastructure: everything runs on Zoho Cloud, which provides secure hosting, authentication, automatic backups, scalability, monitoring, and high availability.
- Data Flow: End Users → Zoho Creator Platform → Database → Integrations → Cloud Infrastructure.

Dashboard

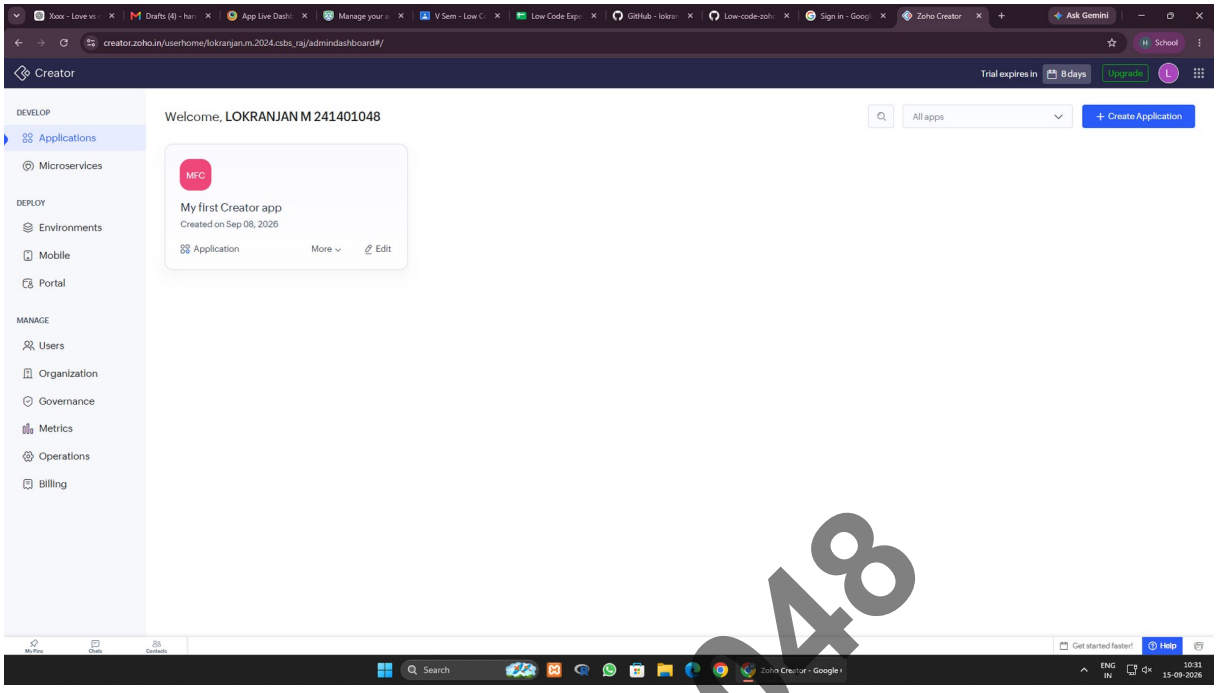


Figure 2: Zoho Creator dashboard - home screen

241401048

- The Dashboard is the home page of Zoho Creator, and is the first screen a user sees right after logging in.
- It lists every application in the account in one place, with an option to create a new one or open an existing one.
- The account used here shows one application, "My first Creator app," created on Sep 08, 2026.
- A search bar and an "All apps" filter help locate applications quickly as the account grows.
- The left navigation groups features under Develop (Applications, Microservices), Deploy (Environments, Mobile, Portal), and Manage (Users, Organization, Governance, Metrics, Operations, Billing).
- The top bar shows the trial status ("Trial expires in 8 days") and an upgrade option.
- Overall, the dashboard acts as the central control panel for developing and managing applications.

Microservices

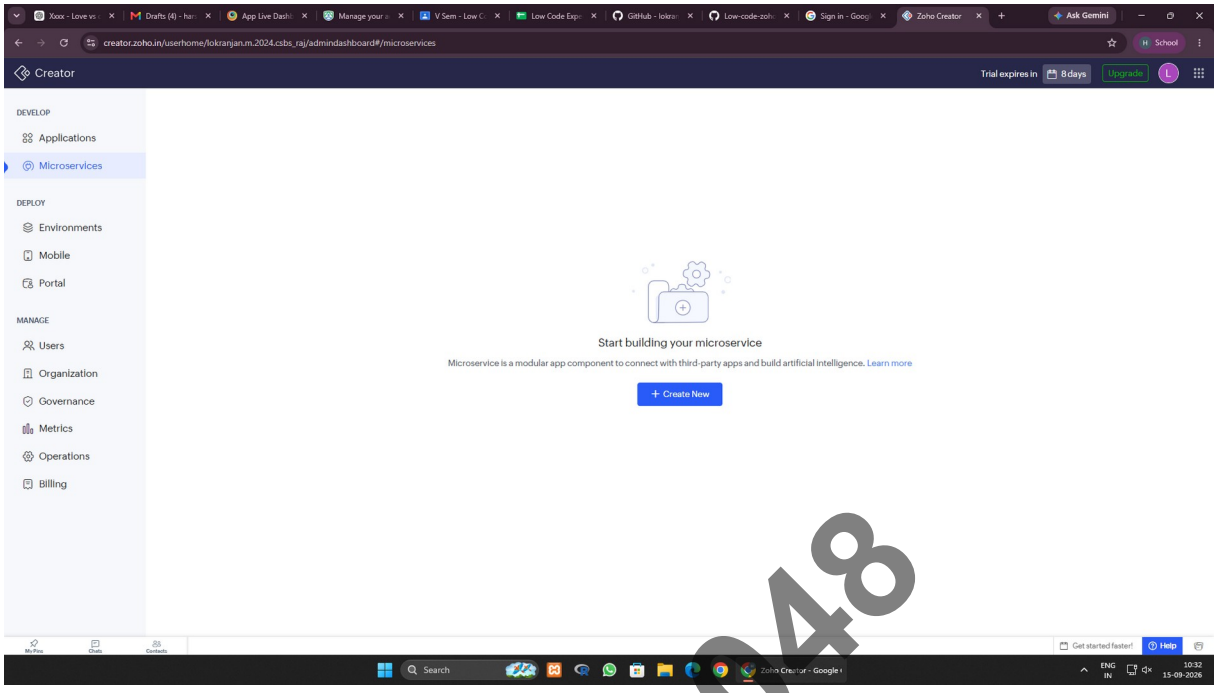


Figure 3: Microservices - start building screen

- Microservices are modular add-ons that extend an application's capabilities with things like AI, third-party connections, and custom APIs.
- No microservice has been created yet in this account, so the panel shows a “Start building your microservice” prompt with a Create New button.
- Typical microservice types available in Zoho Creator include AI Models, an AR Library, Connections, Datasources, and Custom API.
- These let a developer plug in intelligence, augmented-reality assets, external integrations, or outside data sources without rebuilding the core application.

2114011048

Environments (Deployment)

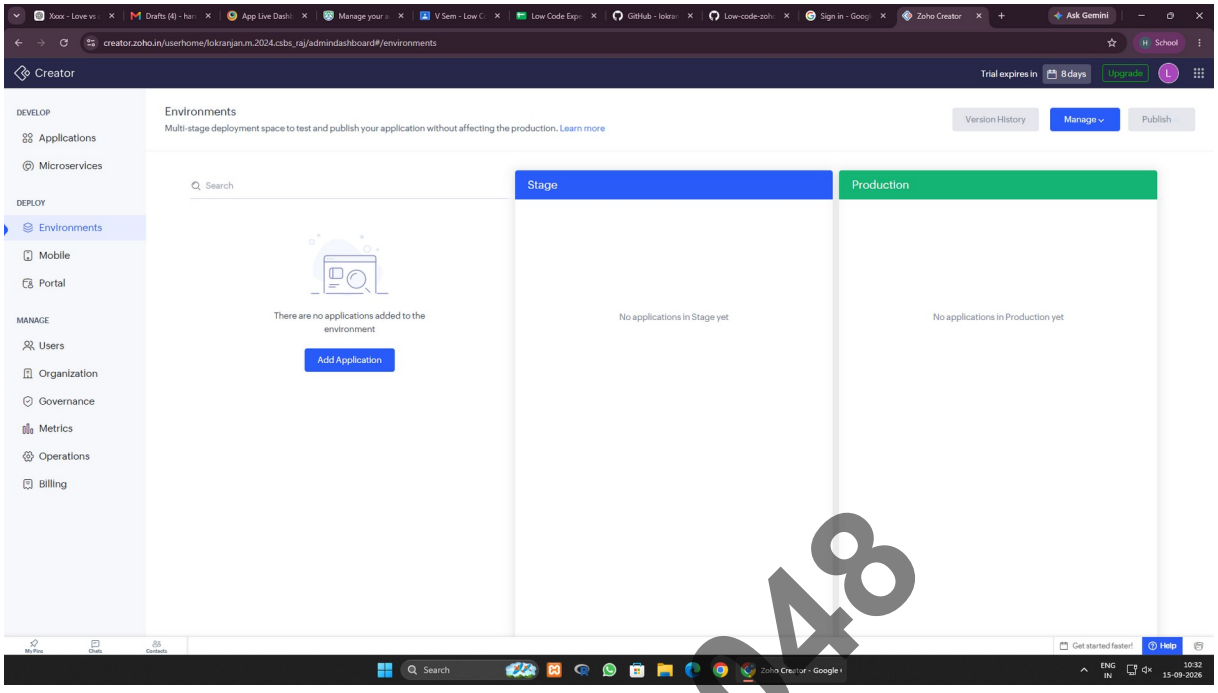


Figure 4: Environments - Stage and Production

- The Environments page gives a multi-stage deployment space to test and publish an application without disturbing the live, production version.
- It is split into a Stage column and a Production column; both are currently empty ("No applications in Stage yet" / "No applications in Production yet").
- Stage is where an app is verified before release; Production holds the final version that end users access.
- Controls in the top-right - Add Application, Version History, Manage, and Publish - let a developer move an application through this pipeline and track its version history.

2414011048

Mobile (Deployment)

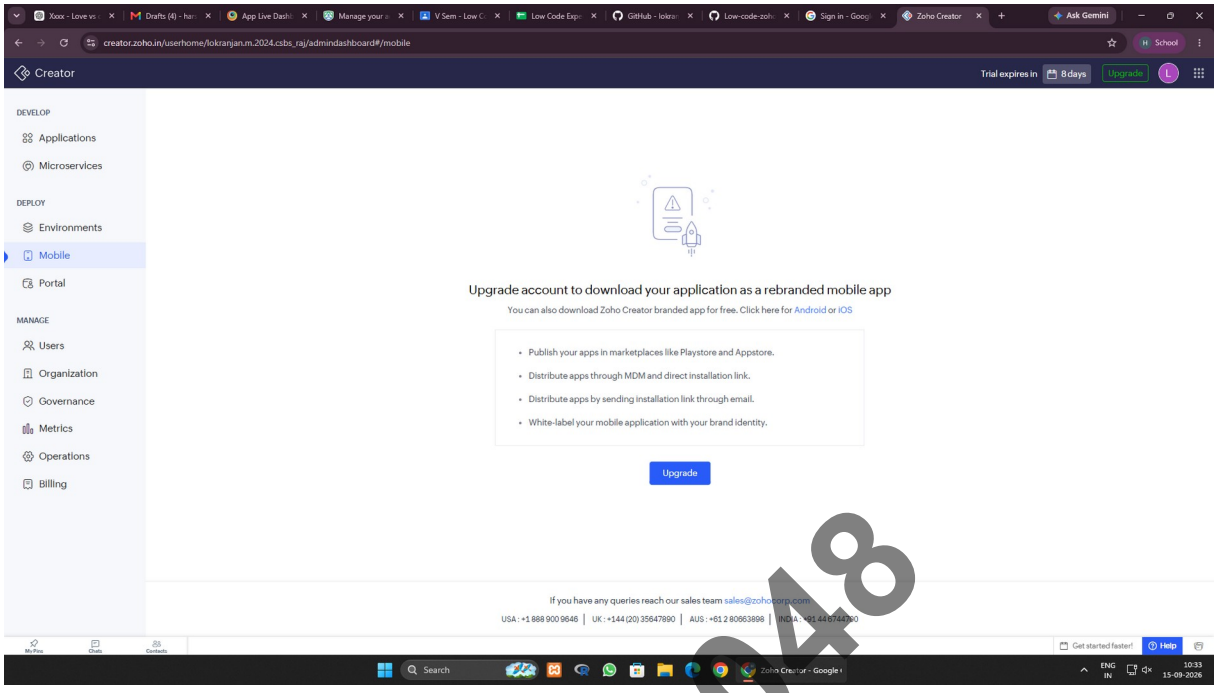


Figure 5: Mobile - app distribution options

- The Mobile page covers turning an application into a mobile app.
- On a trial account, publishing a rebranded mobile app requires an upgrade; the page instead offers the free, Zoho Creator-branded app for Android or iOS.
- Once upgraded, the listed capabilities include publishing to the Play Store and App Store, distributing through MDM or a direct install link, sharing an install link by email, and white-labelling the app with the organization's own branding.

24140148

Portal (Deployment)

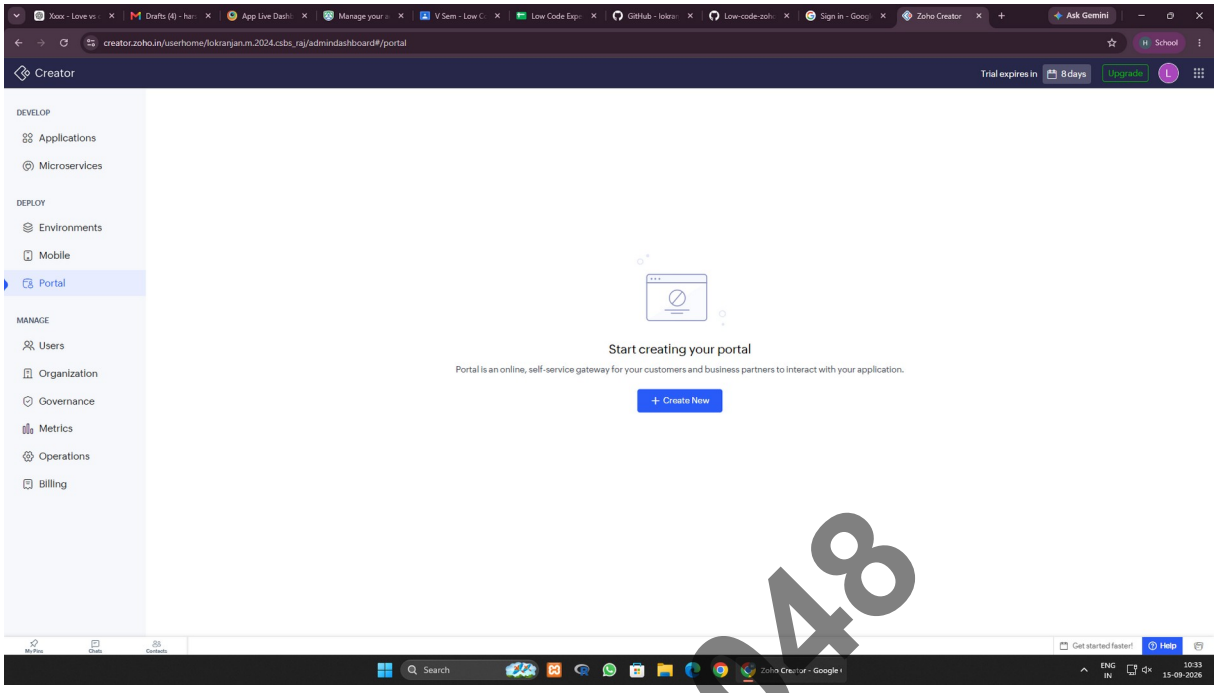


Figure 6: Portal - start creating screen

- A Portal is a self-service gateway that lets external users - customers or business partners - interact with an application without needing an internal Zoho Creator account.
- No portal has been created yet in this account, so the page shows a “Start creating your portal” prompt with a Create New button.
- Once set up, a portal typically allows external users to register and log in with their own credentials while administrators retain control over what data they can view or edit.

2414011048

Users (Manage)

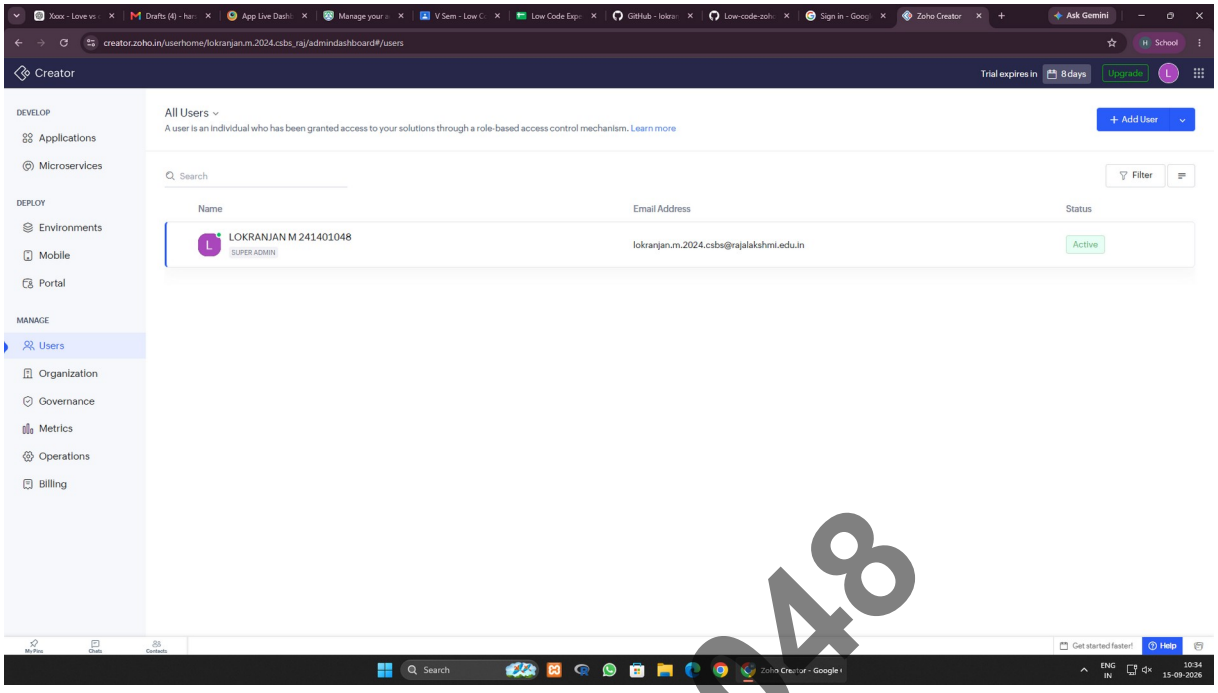


Figure 7: All Users screen

241401048

- The Users page lists everyone who has been granted access to the account's applications through role-based access control.
- Currently there is a single user, LOKRANJAN M, holding the Super Admin role, with an Active status.
- An Add User button and Filter option support inviting more users and narrowing the list as the team grows.
- Roles such as Admin, Developer, or User can be assigned to control what each person is permitted to view, edit, create, or delete.

Organization (Manage)

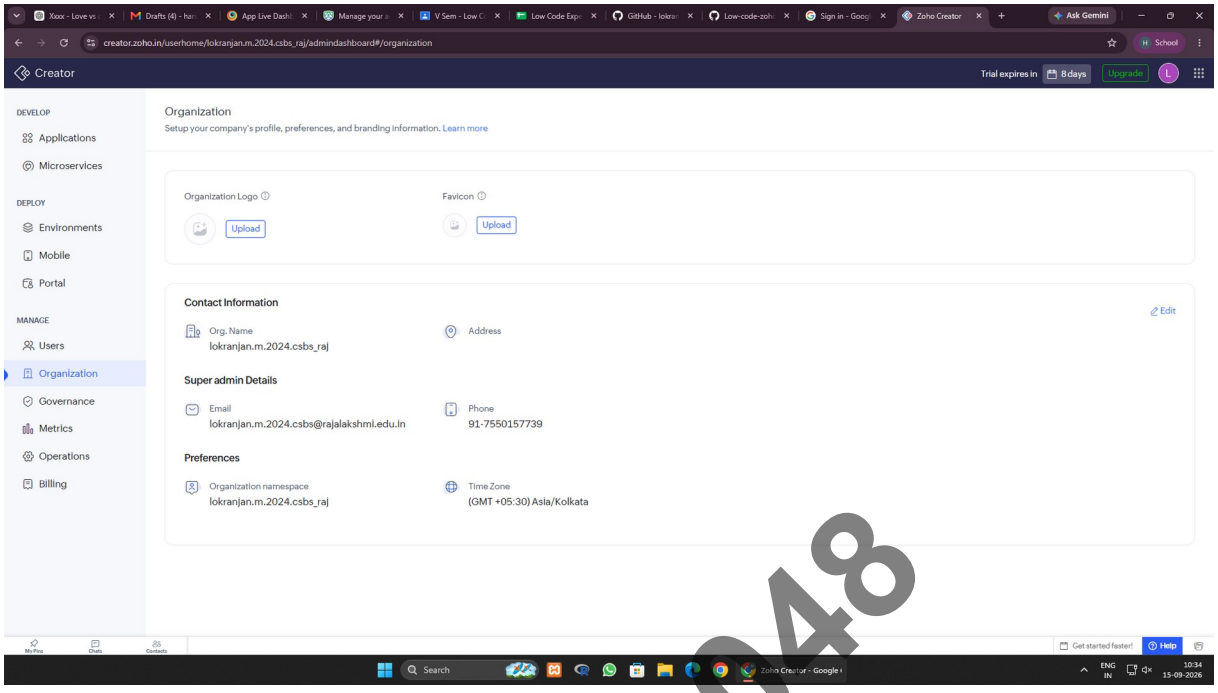


Figure 8: Organization profile and preferences

- The Organization page holds the account's company profile, branding, and preference settings.
- The organization name and namespace are set to "lokranjan.m.2024.csbs_raj", with the super admin email lokranjan.m.2024.csbs@rajalakshmi.edu.in and phone 91-7550157739.
- The time zone is set to (GMT +05:30) Asia/Kolkata.
- Options to upload an organization logo and favicon are available for branding the account, along with an Edit link to update contact details.

2414101048

Governance (Manage)

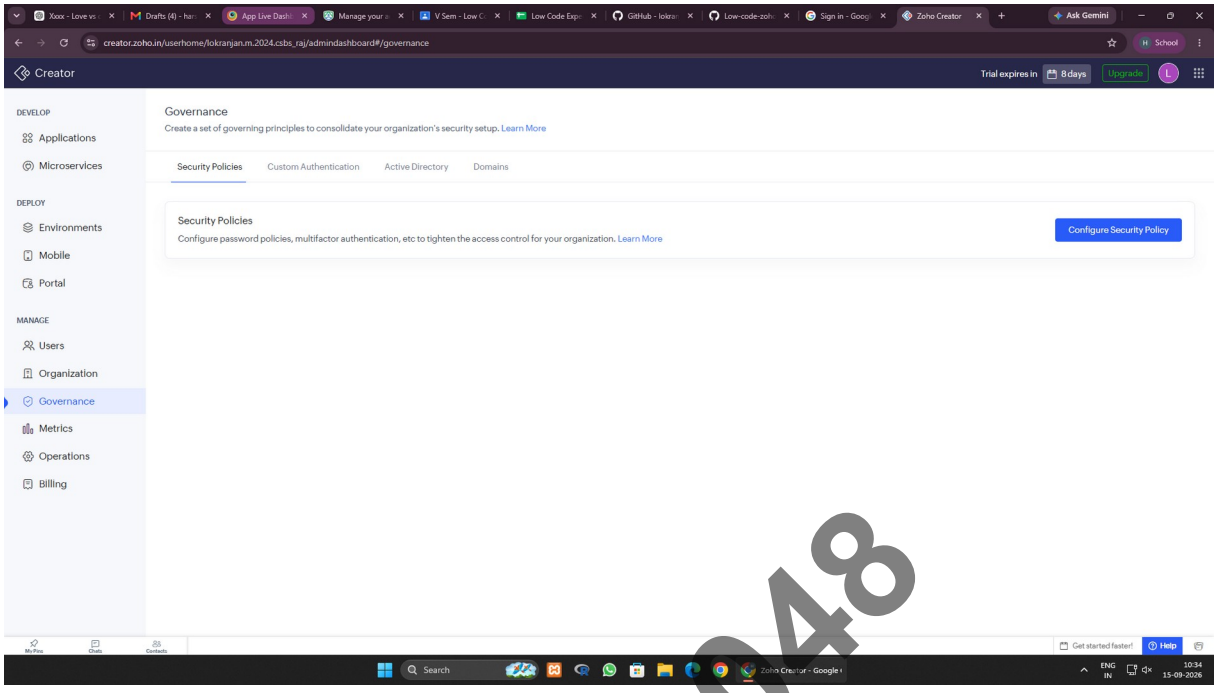


Figure 9: Governance - Security Policies

- Governance brings together the organization's security setup under one place, with tabs for Security Policies, Custom Authentication, Active Directory, and Domains.
- The Security Policies tab lets an admin configure password policies, multi-factor authentication, and other access controls via a Configure Security Policy button.
- This helps ensure that access to the account and its applications follows a consistent, organization-wide standard.

241101048

Metrics (Manage)

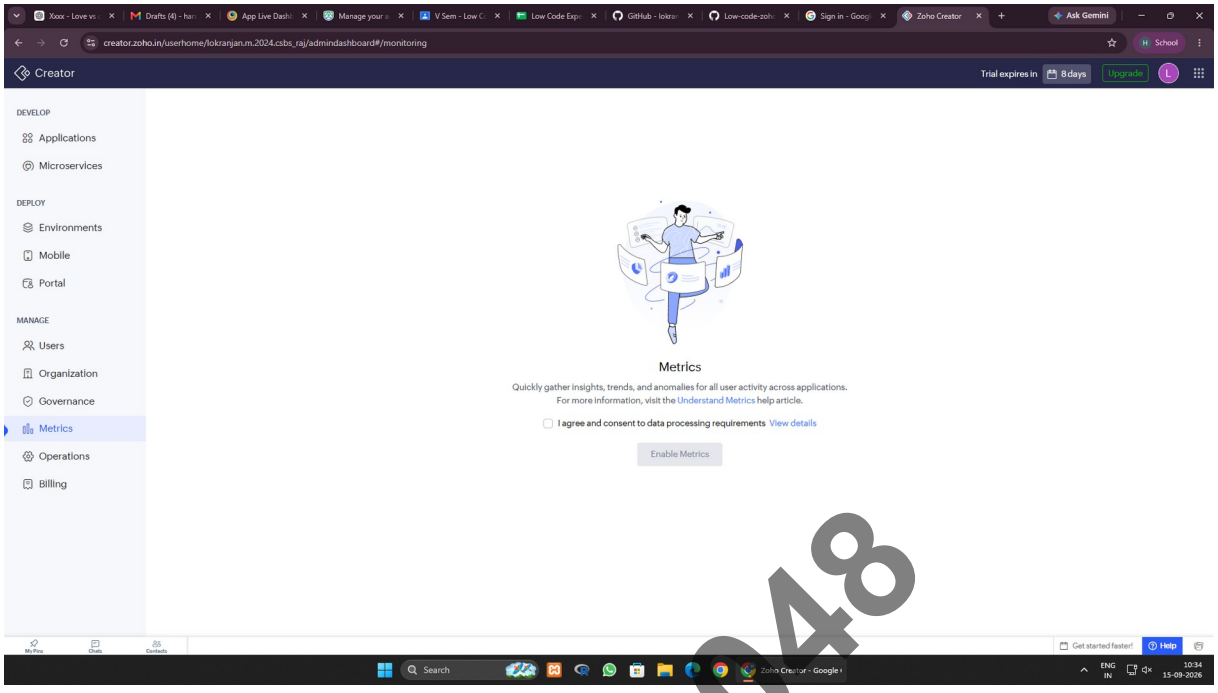


Figure 10: Metrics - enable screen

- The Metrics page is meant to surface insights, trends, and anomalies across all user activity in the account's applications.
- It is not yet enabled here; a consent checkbox ("I agree and consent to data processing requirements") must be ticked before clicking Enable Metrics.
- Once enabled, this feature would help track usage patterns and application health over time.

24140 1048

Operations (Manage)

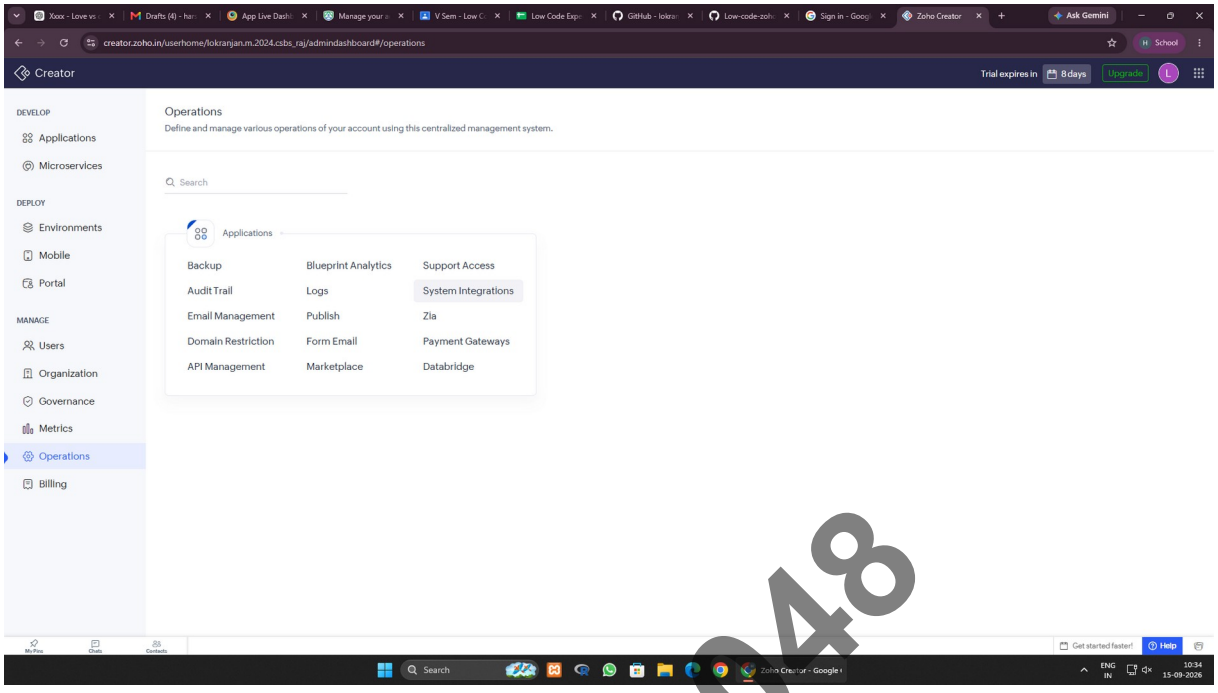


Figure 11: Operations - Applications tools

- The Operations page centralizes management tools for the account, organized under an Applications section.
- Tools listed include Backup, Audit Trail, Email Management, Domain Restriction, API Management, Blueprint Analytics, Logs, Publish, Form Email, Marketplace, Support Access, System Integrations, Zia, Payment Gateways, and Databridge.
- Together these support maintenance tasks such as backups, troubleshooting via logs, and managing integrations and third-party connections.

2414O1048

Billing (Manage)

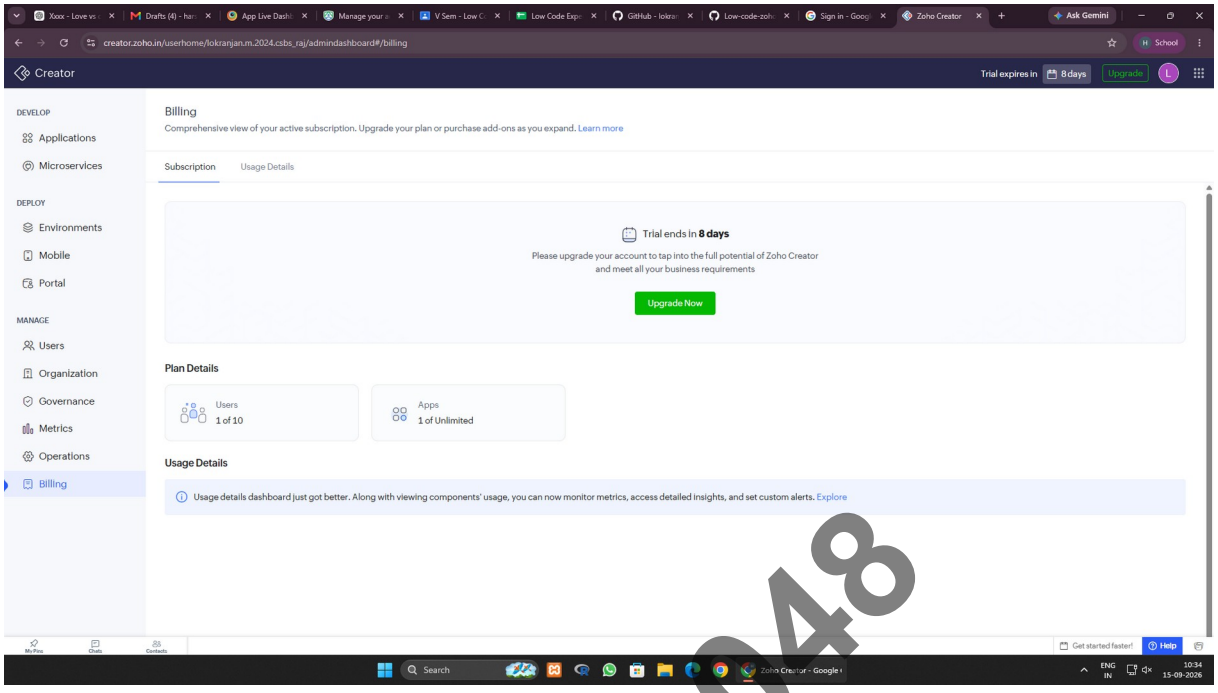


Figure 12: Billing - subscription overview

- The Billing page gives a comprehensive view of the active subscription, with Subscription and Usage Details tabs.
- The account is currently on a trial that ends in 8 days, with an Upgrade Now option to move to a paid plan.
- Plan Details show usage of 1 of 10 available user seats and 1 of unlimited application slots.
- A newer Usage Details dashboard is highlighted, offering component-level usage monitoring, detailed insights, and custom alerts.

2414010148

Summary

This exercise walked through setting up a Zoho Creator trial account and exploring its main areas: the Dashboard for managing applications, Microservices for extending functionality, the Environments and Portal pages for deployment, Mobile for app distribution, and the Manage section (Users, Organization, Governance, Metrics, Operations, and Billing) for administering the account. Together these areas give a first look at how Zoho Creator organizes application development, deployment, and account management on a single low-code platform.